



Surgical Exposure of Impacted Teeth (for Orthodontic Bonding)

Purpose: Surgical uncovering of an impacted tooth, often followed by bonding of an orthodontic bracket to help guide the tooth into place.

First 24 Hours:

- Mild bleeding and swelling are normal.
- Apply ice packs externally in 15-minute intervals to control swelling.
- Avoid spitting, rinsing, or using straws for the first 24 hours.

Pain & Sensitivity:

- Use prescribed or OTC pain relievers as directed.
- Some soreness and jaw stiffness are normal.

Oral Hygiene:

- Brush gently around the surgical site with a soft-bristled toothbrush.
- Use prescribed antimicrobial rinses to maintain cleanliness.

Diet:

- Eat soft, cool foods for the first few days.
- Avoid hard, crunchy, or sticky foods that could dislodge the bracket or irritate the site.

Special Precautions:

- Avoid pulling on lips or cheeks to inspect the surgical area.
- Follow all orthodontist instructions regarding elastics or traction devices attached to the bracket.

Follow-Up:

- Sutures may dissolve or require removal.
- Contact the office if the bracket comes off, excessive bleeding occurs, or there are signs of infection.